Thundersoft (300496.SZ): In-house AIOS to empower smart automotive and AI devices; Sell

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Thundersoft continues to enhance its AIOS and AI agent technology to empower the automotive, IoT and smartphones segments, meanwhile expanding to the Embodied AI solution. The company delivered strong 2Q26 revenues growth at 40% YoY to Rmb2.6bn, supported by IoT revenues growth at 47% YoY in 1H26, followed by smart automotive at 14% and smart software at 22% YoY. Due to the product mix change, 2Q26 GM was lower than expected at 27% (vs. 31% in 2Q25). Management has highlighted that the company develops AquaClaw for IoT to integrate Agent OS on the AI native devices, supporting the AI features of AI glasses, smart home, meeting devices, robotics etc. While we are positive on the company's long-term growth potential in the AI era, we remain concerned about near-term margins on product mix changes and new product ramp-ups. Maintain Sell.

AI automotive products in expansion: The company has adopted its in-house AquaClaw on vehicles to enhance the driver and passenger experiences, for example, preparing the car remotely before getting in vehicles, opening the trunk based on the AI recognition. The AI capabilities have extended from the AI voice to cockpit access and with deep user interactions. Besides this, the company has also launched the AI Box as the computing platform to support the stable operation of AIOS.

Earnings revision: We factor in Thundersoft's 2Q26 result and revise our 2026E/2027E earnings by -1%/2%, and also introduce 2028E earnings. We revise up 2026E/2027E revenues mainly on high-than-expected IoT revenues supported by AIOS enhancement, while revising down GM to reflect product mix changes.

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Exhibit 1: Earnings revision

	2025			2026E			2027E			2028E		
Rmb m	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %
Revenues	7,106	7,778	9%	8,427	9,615	14%	10,958	12,109	10%		15,176	
GP	2,221	2,463	11%	2,779	2,937	6%	3,732	3,950	6%		4,980	
OP	320	376	18%	629	700	11%	900	976	8%		1,101	
Net income	369	450	22%	649	639	-1%	871	890	2%		994	
Margins												
GM	31.3%	31.7%		33.0%	30.5%		34.1%	32.6%			32.8%	
OPM	4.5%	4.8%		7.5%	7.3%		8.2%	8.1%			7.3%	
NM	5.2%	5.8%		7.7%	6.6%		8.0%	7.4%			6.5%	
Opex	26.8%	26.8%		25.5%	23.3%		25.8%	24.6%			25.6%	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation: Our 12m target price is derived from a DCF-based methodology (unchanged) to better capture long-term cash flow generation. We model stage 2 FCF growth in 2032E-2036E at 6% YoY, and terminal growth at 2%. We discount the value at a WACC of 10.9%, with a COE of 10.1% (beta at 1.2, risk free rate at 3.0%, market risk premium at 6.0%); no change to assumptions. With this, our DCF based target price is Rmb47.47 (vs. previously at Rmb53.97). Our TP implied 2027E P/S is at 2x, and the implied 2026E P/S multiple is in line with the company's historical P/S trading range.

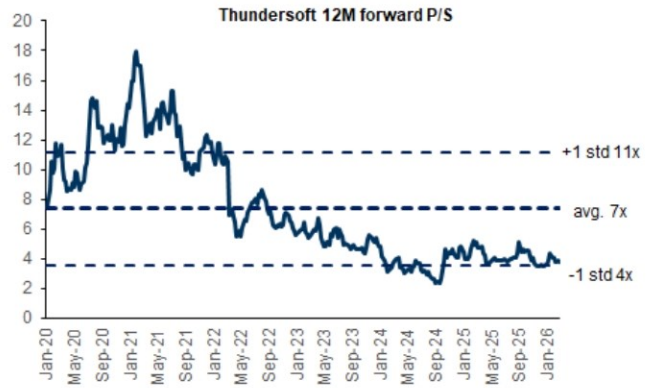
Exhibit 2: Thundersoft DCF valuation

	Stage 1											Stage 2				
Rmb mn	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E	2032E	2033E	2034E	2035E	2036E
P&L																
Revenue	4,127	5,445	5,242	5,385	7,778	9,615	12,109	15,176	18,211	21,489	24,713					
YoY	*57%*	*32%*	*-4%*	*3%*	*44%*	*24%*	*26%*	*25%*	*20%*	*18%*	*15%*					
Opex ratio	25.7%	27.7%	31.7%	32.1%	26.8%	23.3%	24.6%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%					
OP income	565	630	276	116	376	700	976	1,101	6,556	7,951	9,391					
YoY	*48%*	*11%*	*-56%*	*-58%*	*224%*	*86%*	*39%*	*13%*	*495%*	*21%*	*18%*					
Pretax income	642	764	424	441	531	765	1,027	1,141	6,596	7,991	9,431					
Net income	647	769	466	407	450	639	890	994	5,973	7,236	8,540					
YoY	*46%*	*19%*	*-39%*	*-13%*	*10%*	*42%*	*39%*	*12%*	*501%*	*21%*	*18%*					
GPM	39.4%	39.3%	36.9%	34.3%	31.7%	30.5%	32.6%	35.0%	36.0%	37.0%	38.0%					
OPM	13.7%	11.6%	5.3%	2.2%	4.8%	7.3%	8.1%	7.3%	36.0%	37.0%	38.0%					
NPM	15.7%	14.1%	8.9%	7.6%	5.8%	6.6%	7.4%	6.5%	32.8%	33.7%	34.6%					
R&D spending (Rmb m)	513	847	951	1,028	1,211	1,361	1,830	2,323								
R&D%	12.4%	15.5%	18.1%	19.1%	15.6%	14.2%	15.1%	15.3%								
Large-scale auto cockpit rev (Rmb m)	148	261	544	287	282	296	1,104	-								
Mid-scale auto cockpit rev (Rmb m)	491	765	1,100	1,090	1,346	1,650	2,264	-								
IoT SOM shipment (m units)	6	8	7	7	8	9	11	-								
IoT SOM ASP (Rmb)	201	194	173	165	155	147	140	-								
Cash flow																
CCC	141	156	186	165	127	104	73	68	66	64	62					
Capex	(462)	(516)	(446)	(1,045)	(1,341)	(1,154)	(1,090)	(911)	(493)	(388)	(446)					
Capex to revenues	*11%*	*9%*	*9%*	*19%*	*17%*	*12%*	*9%*	*6%*	*3%*	*2%*	*2%*					
Free cash flow	**(323)**	**(19)**	**309**	**(292)**	**(662)**	**291**	**92**	**(196)**	**820**	**1,331**	**1,778**	**1,885**	**1,998**	**2,118**	**2,245**	**2,379**
YoY		na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	62%	34%	6%	6%	6%	6%	6%
Terminal growth																2.0%
Terminal value																27,157
Discount factor							1.00	0.90	0.81	0.73	0.66	0.60	0.54	0.48	0.44	0.39
Present value of FCF							92	(177)	667	975	1,174	1,122	1,072	1,024	978	935
Enterprise value 2027E (Rmb m)							**18,532**									
Cash and equivalents (net)							3,384									
Equity value in 2027E (Rmb m)							**21,916**									
Value per share (Rmb)							**47.47**									
Implied 2027E P/E							**25x**									
Implied 2027E EV/Sales							**2x**									

WACC assumption (2027E)	
Risk free rate	3.0%
Beta	1.22
Market risk premium	6.5%
Cost of equity	10.9%
Cost of debt	6.0%
Tax rate	15%
Long-run Debt to Asset ratio	0.0%
Equity /(debt+equity)	100.0%
WACC	**10.9%**

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Thundersoft 12M forward P/S



Source: Eikon Datastream

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Thundersoft

Valuation methodology: We derive our 12m TP of Rmb47.47, which is derived from a two-stage DCF, where we incorporate a WACC of 10.9% and a terminal growth at 2% YoY. We are Sell rated on Thundersoft.

Key upside risks: 1) stronger-than-expected digitalization in cars; 2) stronger-than-expected royalty fees growth; and 3) lower-than-expected competition in auto OS.

300496.SZ	12m Price Target: **Rmb47.47**	Price: **Rmb52.92**	Downside: **10.3%**

Sell

Market cap: Rmb24.3bn / $3.6bn
Enterprise value: Rmb21.4bn / $3.2bn
3m ADTV: Rmb701.2mn / $104.0mn
China
Greater China Technology
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (Rmb mn) New	**7,778.0**	**9,614.9**	**12,108.6**	**15,176.0**
Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	7,105.8	8,427.4	10,958.2	–
EBITDA (Rmb mn)	818.9	1,163.5	1,456.0	1,602.4
EPS (Rmb) New	**0.98**	**1.39**	**1.93**	**2.15**
EPS (Rmb) Old	0.80	1.41	1.89	–
P/E (X)	63.4	38.2	27.5	24.6
P/B (X)	2.8	2.2	2.1	1.9
Dividend yield (%)	0.3	0.5	0.8	0.0
CROCI (%)	16.2	11.3	12.7	12.5

	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (Rmb)	0.31	0.28	0.57	0.40

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 9 Oct 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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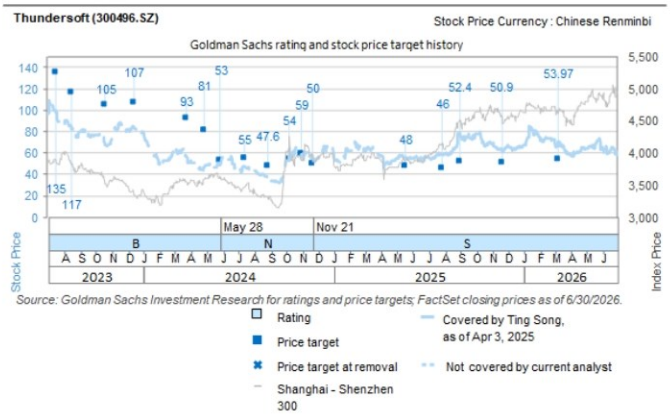
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Target price history table(s)

Thundersoft (300496.SZ)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
09-Mar-26	53.97	70.61
20-Nov-25	50.90	62.90
01-Sep-25	52.40	78.31
28-Jul-25	46.00	59.22
19-May-25	48.00	56.19
21-Nov-24	50.00	57.13
30-Oct-24	59.00	58.85
07-Oct-24	54.00	52.55
28-Aug-24	47.60	32.83
14-Jul-24	55.00	47.86
28-May-24	53.00	48.38
27-Apr-24	81.00	46.58
23-Mar-24	93.00	57.50
14-Dec-23	107.00	83.30
20-Oct-23	105.00	67.66

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